How to Word It

Making the Mansion House answer sound like a person who finds this interesting, rather than a candidate who prepared. The hook, the voice, the Goldman link, and the one thing in your answer that nobody else could say.

Doc 36 · Companion to doc 35 · Asset Management, Client Solutions Group · Prepared 4 November 2026

1 The real problem, named properly

You cannot say "I find this interesting" and be believed. Everybody says it. The word does no work.

> Interest is not a feeling you announce. It is **a gap between what you expected and what you found.** You make it audible by naming the expectation.

Think about how you actually talk when something genuinely grabbed you. You never open with "I find this interesting." You open with the surprise. *"You know what's mad about it…"* or *"I thought it was X, turns out it's completely the other way round."*

That is the technique. Not enthusiasm in your voice. **A stated expectation, then the thing that broke it.** Once that structure is in the words, the interest is self-evident and you never have to claim it.

Your gap, for this story

Here is yours, and it is real. You read a headline about pension money going into British private markets to fund growth and infrastructure. You then looked at the breakdown and found that nearly three quarters of it bought *property*, and the growth-capital bit got about one pound in twenty-two.

That is a genuine expectation violated. You expected the money to match the purpose. It did not. Everything else in your answer flows from naming that out loud.

2 Seven things that make speech sound genuinely interested

These are specific and learnable. Most are about adding four or five words, not about changing the content.

MARKER 1

Report your reaction, not just the fact

SCRIPTED

"Eight billion of the eleven billion went into real estate."

INTERESTED

"Eight billion of the eleven went into property. That's the bit that made me stop."

Same fact. Eight extra words. The second version tells the listener a human processed it. Phrases that do this work: *that's the bit that got me, I had to read that twice, that's what I keep coming back to.*

MARKER 2

Admit how you found out

A scripted answer arrives fully formed, as if you were born knowing it. Genuine interest has a history — you read something, then you looked at something else.

SCRIPTED

"The Mansion House Accord update showed that providers are at 6.6% against a 10% target."

INTERESTED

"I'd seen the headline, which was basically that they're behind target. But then I actually looked at the breakdown underneath it."

"But then I actually looked at" is a very powerful five words. It tells the reviewer you did something the other candidates did not, without you having to claim it.

MARKER 3

Use the odd specific, not the round one

Scripted answers reach for the headline figure. Interested people reach for the strange one, because that is what stuck.

SCRIPTED

"They have allocated £11.1 billion to UK private markets."

INTERESTED

"Private equity got five hundred million. Out of eleven billion. So about one pound in twenty-two."

The second one is memorable because it is a *ratio* you worked out, not a number you copied.

MARKER 4

Let one sentence repair itself

Real speech is not clean. Scripts are. One small self-correction makes everything around it sound live.

SCRIPTED	INTERESTED
"Approximately 4.5 per cent of the UK allocation was deployed into private equity."	"Private equity got about four per cent of it — well, five hundred million out of eleven billion."

One of these per answer. Two or three starts to sound like you are struggling, which is the opposite effect.

MARKER 5

Say what you were wrong about

Nothing signals genuine engagement like having changed your mind. It is impossible to fake convincingly and reviewers know it.

"I'll be honest, my first reaction was that the providers were just dragging their feet. But when you look at why property won, it's less about willingness and more that it's the only one you can actually deploy at that scale quickly."

That sentence does three jobs at once: it shows a thought process, it shows fairness toward the people being criticised, and it makes your eventual conclusion sound earned rather than loaded.

MARKER 6

Leave something open

Scripted answers tie a neat bow. Interested people are still thinking about it.

SCRIPTED	INTERESTED
"So in conclusion, the Accord demonstrates the importance of capability building in private markets."	"What I don't know yet is whether the next update shows the mix shifting. That's the thing I'd actually want to see."

An open question at the end is also your falsifier, so this marker and the scoring criterion are the same move.

MARKER 7

Shorter sentences than you would write

Written English runs long. Spoken English runs short. If a sentence has more than one comma in it, you will sound like you are reading.

WRITTEN, SO SOUNDS READ

"The composition of the allocation, which reveals a significant skew toward real estate, suggests that the binding constraint is capability rather than willingness."

SPOKEN

"The money went in. It just didn't go where the policy wanted. And I think that's a capability thing, not a willingness thing."

Three short sentences beat one long one every time on camera.

3 The hook: anatomy and five worked versions

Fifteen seconds is about **40 to 50 spoken words.** That is less than you think. Count it on your fingers.

The structure

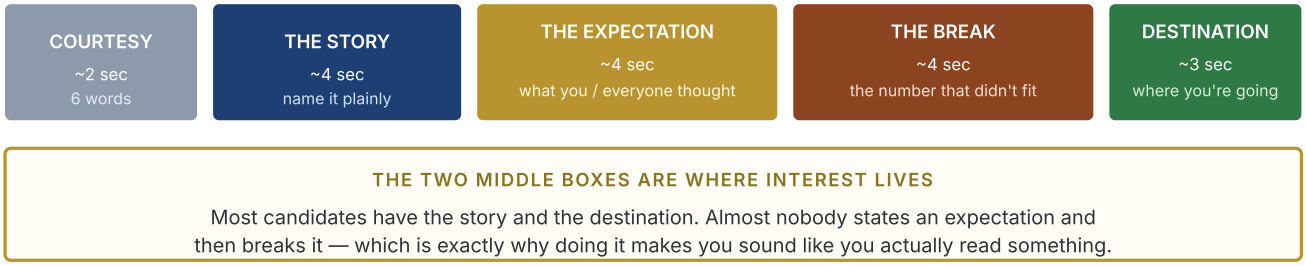


Figure 1 — The 15-second hook. Five boxes, roughly 45 words.

Five versions. Pick the one that sounds most like you, then rewrite it in your own words.

VERSION 1 — THE PLAIN EXPECTATION GAP · 48 WORDS · RECOMMENDED

"Thanks for taking the time to watch this. So the thing I've been reading about is UK pension funds investing in British private markets. The headline is that they're behind target. But what actually got me was the breakdown — nearly three quarters of it went into property."

Why it works: states the common view ("the headline is"), then breaks it ("but what actually got me"). The phrase *"what actually got me"* is doing almost all the work. Safest and most natural of the five.

VERSION 2 — THE TWO NUMBERS THAT DON'T FIT · 46 WORDS

"Thanks for watching this. UK pension providers promised to put ten per cent of people's retirement savings into private markets by 2030. The first progress report came out a couple of weeks ago, and two numbers in it sat really oddly together — eight billion, and five hundred million."

Why it works: ends on a cliffhanger. The reviewer now wants to know what those two numbers are, which is the strongest possible reason to keep watching. **Risk:** you must resolve it immediately in beat 2 or it reads as a gimmick.

VERSION 3 — THE HUMAN STAKE · 50 WORDS

"Thanks for taking the time. The story I've been following is about where our pension money actually goes — most people never choose, so a handful of providers decide for millions of us. They promised to put more of it into British private markets, and the first scorecard just came out."

Why it works: "most people never choose" makes it about real people and is genuinely true. Warmest of the five. **Risk:** spends four seconds on framing before any number arrives, so beat 2 has to deliver fast.

VERSION 4 — THE ADMISSION · 47 WORDS

"Thanks for watching. I've been following the Mansion House Accord, which is UK pension providers agreeing to put ten per cent into private markets by 2030. I'll be honest, I assumed the story was just that they're behind. Then I looked at what the money actually bought."

Why it works: *"I'll be honest, I assumed"* is the single most interest-signalling construction available. Admitting a first impression and then revising it is almost impossible to fake. **Best if you are naturally understated.**

VERSION 5 — STRAIGHT AND CONFIDENT · 44 WORDS

"Thanks for taking the time to watch this. UK pension providers published their first progress report on moving retirement money into private markets. They're about two thirds of the way to the 2030 target. But the money went somewhere quite different from where the policy intended."

Why it works: cleanest and most professional. **Risk:** no personal reaction in it at all, so you have to supply the warmth through delivery rather than words. Use only if you are confident on camera.

HOW TO CHOOSE

Read all five out loud. **Not in your head — out loud.** One of them will feel like something you would actually say and the others will feel like costume. Take that one and change three or four words to your own. The version you half-wrote yourself will always beat the version I wrote.

4 The same answer, both ways

Identical content. The left column is what a prepared candidate produces. The right is what a person who read something produces. Read them both aloud and you will hear it immediately.

PREPARED CANDIDATE

"Thank you for the opportunity to discuss this. A recent development that I have been following closely is the Mansion House Accord, under which seventeen UK pension providers committed to allocating ten per cent of their defined contribution default funds to private markets by 2030."

"The first progress update, published in October, revealed that signatories have reached 6.6 per cent globally and 3.3 per cent domestically, representing approximately two thirds of the stated objective."

"Analysis of the composition reveals a significant concentration in real estate, which accounted for £8 billion of the £11.1 billion UK allocation, while private equity received only £500 million."

"This demonstrates the importance of investment capability in private markets and creates a significant opportunity for asset managers with established expertise in this area."

"In conclusion, I believe this is a highly interesting development with important implications for the industry."

PERSON WHO READ SOMETHING

"Thanks for taking the time to watch this. So the thing I've been reading about is UK pension funds putting money into British private markets. The headline is that they're behind target. But what actually got me was the breakdown."

"Eight billion out of eleven went into property. Private equity got five hundred million. So about one pound in twenty-two — and private equity is the bit the whole policy was argued for."

"I'll be honest, my first thought was that providers were just dragging their feet. But I don't think that's it. Property is the one you can actually buy at that scale — one building, one transaction, and they already had property teams. Private equity is hundreds of small deals and you need a team that most of them haven't got."

"And they've basically said that. Pensions UK talked about needing to hire people and build relationships. That's the client side saying out loud they've been asked to buy something they can't currently buy."

"What I don't know is whether the mix shifts next time. That's the thing I'd actually want to see."

What changed, specifically

The move	Where to see it
Expectation stated, then broken	"The headline is that they're behind. But what actually got me was the breakdown."
A ratio you worked out	"About one pound in twenty-two" instead of "£500 million."
A mind changed on camera	"My first thought was they were dragging their feet. But I don't think that's it."
Fairness to the people criticised	Explaining *why* property won rather than just complaining it did.
Quoting them rather than claiming it	"And they've basically said that" — the bridge is their words, not your argument.
Ending open	"What I don't know is whether the mix shifts next time."
Every long sentence broken up	Right column averages about twelve words a sentence. Left averages twenty-six.

5 Linking to Goldman without sounding like you are pitching

You asked how to link it back. The most important advice here is counterintuitive, so read it twice.

The question was "tell us about some market news." **It was not "why Goldman."** A heavy link reads as a candidate who cannot stop selling. One clause reads as someone who naturally connects things.

The three strengths, ranked by how natural they sound

LINK A — ONE CLAUSE AT THE VERY END · BEST

"…and it's presumably part of why the third-party distribution channel here has been the fastest growing of the three, up about thirty-six per cent last year."

Why: it is a fact about Goldman's own reported numbers, it arrives as an aside rather than a pitch, and it quietly proves you read a filing. Nine seconds. **This is the one to use.**

LINK B — THE CAPABILITY POINT, ONE SENTENCE

"…which is really a demand signal. Seventeen providers with a public 2030 deadline who've said they lack the capability is a route into a channel, and it's the kind of thing a firm with an established alternatives platform is positioned for."

Why: makes the commercial logic explicit. **Risk:** "a firm with an established alternatives platform" is fractionally close to flattery. Use only if you deliver it flatly, as an observation rather than a compliment.

LINK C — NO EXPLICIT LINK AT ALL

End on your falsifier. Say nothing about Goldman.

Why this is legitimate: your answer is already *about* UK pension providers buying private markets capability. That **is** the division's market. The reviewer will make the connection without help. If you are short on time or the link feels forced on the day, drop it entirely — a clean answer beats a bolted-on one.

THE RULE

Never name Goldman before beat 4. If the firm appears in your opening or your mechanism, the answer reads as a pitch wearing a news story as a disguise. Let the story be a story, and let the link be the last nine seconds.

6 What in this answer nobody else can say

You asked how to make it un-copyable. Let me be honest about which parts actually are.

Element	Could another candidate have it?
The Accord, the 10% target, being behind	**Yes, easily.** This is the headline. Assume several candidates have it.
The composition finding — £8bn property, £0.5bn private equity	**Technically yes, but almost none will.** It requires reading the breakdown rather than the headline. This is your main edge and it is cheap to hold.
The path-of-least-resistance explanation	**Rarely.** It is reasoning, not a fact, so it has to be worked out. Most people will say "they're behind" without asking why.
Quoting the industry admitting the capability gap	**Rarely.** It is in the article but you have to notice that it is a commercial statement rather than an excuse.
The mandation economics — forced demand, fixed supply, higher prices, lower returns	**Rarely, and it suits you.** You are an economics student. This is your discipline being used on a real problem rather than recited.
Your own expectation being broken	**No. Never. By definition.**

Everything factual in your answer could, in principle, be researched by somebody else. **The only genuinely un-copyable thing in any answer is your own reaction to it.** Which is exactly why the expectation-gap structure is not a trick — it is the one part of the answer that is unavailable to anybody but you.

7 Phrases to cut from this specific answer

Cut	Say instead
"I find this really interesting"	Nothing. Show it with an expectation and a break.
"This demonstrates the importance of…"	"So what that tells you is…" or just say the thing.
"The composition reveals a significant concentration in…"	"Most of it went into property."
"Allocating capital to the asset class"	"Buying it."
"Signatories" / "the aforementioned providers"	"They."
"Creates a significant opportunity for asset managers"	"Which is either a hiring problem for them, or somebody else's business."
"In conclusion" / "To summarise"	Nothing. You have two minutes; nobody needs a summary.
"It will be interesting to see how this develops"	Your falsifier: "What I'd want to see is whether the mix shifts."
"Approximately 4.5 per cent"	"About one pound in twenty-two."

8 How to rehearse so it does not sound rehearsed

1. **Write nothing down beyond this.** On one piece of paper: the four beats, and the four numbers — *10% target, 6.6% actual, £8bn property, £0.5bn private equity.* That is the whole memorisation load. If you write full sentences, you will reproduce them, and the reviewer will hear it.
2. **Film it fifteen times, changing the words every time.** Not fifteen attempts at one script. Fifteen different ways of saying the same four beats. By take ten the structure runs itself and your attention goes to tone, which is where warmth comes from.
3. **Do one take deliberately badly.** Ramble, go off, lose your place. It breaks the fear of imperfection, and the take after it is usually the best one you do.
4. **The pub test.** Read each sentence and ask: would I say this to a friend in a pub? "The composition reveals a significant concentration" fails. "Most of it went into property" passes.
5. **Explain it to someone who knows nothing.** If they can repeat back why property won, you own it. If you reach for a phrase you cannot explain, you borrowed it.
6. **Watch two takes back with the sound off.** You are only checking one thing: do you look like someone who wants to be there? That is the entire test, and it is the one most people never run.

9 The final version, with the voice markers highlighted

About 115 seconds. The highlighted phrases are the ones doing the interest work — keep those *functions*, change the words freely.

BEAT 1 — HOOK, ~17 SECONDS

Thanks for taking the time to watch this. So the thing I've been reading about is UK pension funds putting money into British private markets. The headline is basically that they're behind target. But what actually got me was the breakdown underneath it.

BEAT 2 — THE FINDING AND WHY, ~35 SECONDS

Seventeen providers promised ten per cent of people's default pension funds into private markets by 2030. The first progress report came out a couple of weeks ago and they're at six point six. But of the eleven billion that went into UK assets, eight billion went into property. Private equity got five hundred million. So about one pound in twenty-two — and private equity is the bit the whole policy was argued for. I'll be honest, my first thought was that they were dragging their feet. But I don't think that's it. Property is the one you can actually buy at that scale. One building, one transaction, and most of them already had property teams. Private equity is hundreds of small deals and a capability they haven't got.

BEAT 3 — THE BRIDGE, ~28 SECONDS

And they've more or less said that themselves. Pensions UK talked about needing to hire people, get them up to speed, build relationships. The ABI said it needs specialist expertise. That's the client side publicly saying they've been asked to buy something they can't currently buy. Which leaves a provider with a 2030 deadline two options — spend years building a team, or go to someone who already has one.

BEAT 4 — VIEW, TEST AND THE LIGHT GOLDMAN TOUCH, ~32 SECONDS

So I'd say this is being measured by the wrong number. Everyone's arguing about whether six point six is close enough to ten, when the mix tells you more. And I'd be wary of the push to make it compulsory, because if you force a fixed allocation by a fixed date in a market that can't supply it that fast, you just push prices up — and a higher price means a worse return for the savers it's supposed to help. What I don't know yet is whether the next update shows the mix moving. That's the thing I'd actually want to see. Although it does make sense of why third-party distribution has been the fastest growing channel here, up about thirty-six per cent last year.

IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING FROM THIS DOCUMENT

Name what you expected before you say what you found. Everything else — the ratio, the self-correction, the open ending, the short sentences — is decoration on that one move. It is the difference between a candidate reporting research and a person telling you about something that surprised them, and a reviewer can hear it in the first fifteen seconds.

Note on the numbers. All figures are as sourced in doc 35 — the £11.1bn, £8bn, £0.5bn, 6.6% and 10% from the FT of 21 October 2026, and Goldman's 36% third-party channel growth from its Form 10-Q for the period ended 30 September 2026. Re-verify the Accord figures before you record; the update data is as at 31 December 2025 and a newer one may exist by the time you film.